

Chapter 2: Literature Review

2.1 Study of Similar Applications

Study of all the applications is subjected during and till the last update on September 2024, any updates afterwards are not noted down in this case study.

We may not have noted all of the applications in this case study so kindly refer to original documentations for more clarity on the respected applications.

We did case study on:

1. Notion
2. Evernotes
3. Day One
4. Journey

Purpose of the case study is to know what features can benefits our dairy writing application for better user usage.

2.1.1 Notion

Notion is a productivity and note-taking cross-platform application developed by Notion Labs, Inc. It is an online-only organizational tool on many different operating systems, with options for both free and paid subscriptions. It is based in San Francisco, California, United States.

Notion offers a smooth, simple and flexible approach in writing.

Features:

- Reordering text or image at any place in page, we can write something on text editor and can drag and drop the image or text at any place.
- Kanban Board
- Calendar, with location and Todo list integrated.
- Different templates for different works like task template to manage task or projects. Todo list for maintaining Todo, its user customizable.
- Text Summarizer, its paid.
- User Customizable templates, users can forge their own templates.
- Easy to write text editor.

Cons:

- Overly complex
- Very limited offline functions

2.1.2 Evernotes

It is a note-taking platform that helps professionals and organizations to manage tasks and share information as it is a cross-platform application and keeps devices in sync. It offers free plan with basic features, and a premium version for additional features.

Features:

- It has a fast search bar equipped with optical character recognition (OCR) which enables it to search even handwritten text in images.
- As it is available on multiple platform user can sync their notes across devices
- It can keep multiple user(teams) onboard which makes data sharing
- Users can assign tasks to other users and can track the progress
- It has AI features like text summarization, translate and can write content
- User can customize the view page for easy access
- It can link notes, meeting and reminders with calendar

Cons:

- Major number of features are not included in free plan
- Offline mode is only available on desktop
- User can create only limited number of workspaces
- Free plan has a maximum of fifty notes and one notebook per account limitation
- User Interface is confusing and feels cluttered
- Evernote's subscription prices are at higher side
- Limitations in free plans

2.1.3 Journey

Journey is a diary app that helps you capture and organize your thoughts, memories, and experiences. Available on multiple platforms, including Windows, it allows you to add text, photos, videos, and audio to your entries.

Features:

- Sync your journal to the cloud and access it on any device.
- Write journal with rich text formatting.
- View entries in timeline, calendar, map and photo view.
- Share your journal and web links with others.
- End-to-End encryption and lock your journal with passcode, fingerprint, or Face ID
- Automatically add location and weather to entries.
- Add daily reminder.
- Personalize with custom wallpapers and colored themes.
- Export entries to Microsoft Word, ePub and print to PDF.
- Daily coach programs are journaling guide to help you get started on journaling or to help you through your on-going reflections.
- Provides stories feature which includes throwback functionality.

Cons:

- There are no tutorials on how to use most of the features.
- The free function is good but most of the advanced features required subscription.
- Can't even use basic features like Heading, bullet points, font color or different font without subscription.
- Not very user friendly
- Should provide users with free trial feature for limited time
- It doesn't have autocorrect feature
- Doesn't have STT and TTS for Windows and Mac

2.1.4 Day One

Day One is a personal journaling app available for Android, macOS and iOS devices. Some features include: data syncing with multiple devices; end-to-end encryption, Markdown authoring of entries; location, weather, date, time, and other automatic metadata; quick entry menu bar; and reminders.

Features:

- Login: Login interface contains login using google, Facebook, the app's own login, or guest login.
- App User Interface: Option to create a new journal, when clicked, shows option to select cover photo from gallery, take cover photo, export (in the form of zip file or pdf file), or journal settings, which contains.
- Journal settings: Journal name, Description, Color, Stats (entries, photos), End-to-End encryption on or off, advanced settings which show all entries, show on this day, include streaks, and conceal contain. Additional option contains to auto add location or not.
- List: List which helps in making timelines, suggesting daily prompts, habit tracker, etc.
- Calendar: A day-to-day calendar which contains options for daily entries, etc.
- Media show: Media appears here when it is added to journal.
- Map: Shows a timeline of our location where we went, and we can pin it on whatever location we want to. Also shows weather information.
- Cross platform: iOS, Mac and Android.
- Sync: iCloud and Dropbox

Pricing:

- Free version: limited entries and photo storage
- Premium version: unlimited entries and photo storage

Pros:

- Multi-Platform
- Photos and audio attachment
- Tags for filtering journals
- Auto-Location tracking
- End-to-End encryption (premium feature)
- No ads

Cons:

- Many features locked behind subscription
- Complex UI
- Limited offline functionality
- Location to be entered manually.

Point of view:

- It fulfills basically every need a journal user can want, but it has a subscription model, no web version, and users cannot create templates on themselves

Areas of improvement:

- User should be able to make his own template
- End-to-End encryption should be available to all
- There should be a free premium trial
- Other options for login (Facebook, guest, etc.)
- Notifications for saving your streak for journaling

2.2 Comparing our Features with similar applications

A comparison on the features across different platforms including Chronicles.

APP FEATURES	 Chronicles	 Journey	 Notion	 Evernotes	 One Day
Diary Writing	✓	✓	*	*	✓
Custom Templates	✓	\$	✓	✓	\$
Text Summarization	✓	\$	\$	\$	
Export To Pdf,epub	✓	✓	*	*	
Speech To Text/ Text To Speech	✓	*			
Open Diary	✓				

We provide a variety of features like export to epub/pdf, custom templates, STT/TTS, summarization, all for free, while other apps don't, or have a subscription regarding that feature. Also, open diaries and add friend is a feature which is our app-exclusive, other diary writing apps don't provide it.

A lot of side features like to-do list and daily reminders are included as well.